

LENNIE WELLS

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[Google Scholar](#) [LinkedIn](#)

PROFILE

Completed PhD in Statistics/ML at Cambridge. Seeking full-time AI safety research role with maximal impact.

EDUCATION

- **PhD in Statistics and Machine Learning** Oct 2021 – May 2026
University of Cambridge (Cambridge, UK)
Supervised by Sergio Bacallado. Canonical correlation analysis from perspectives on high-dimensional statistics and self-supervised learning; foundations of Bayesian inference and neural processes; reinforcement learning for language models.
- **MMath specialising in probability and statistics** Oct 2020 – Jun 2021
University of Cambridge (Cambridge, UK). Distinction. Rank 10 / 272. Mark 94%.
- **BA in Mathematics** Oct 2017 – Jun 2020
University of Cambridge (Cambridge, UK). High first class (and top mark in college) each year of examination.

AI SAFETY EXPERIENCE

- **Scholar. MATS 9.0** (Berkeley, USA) Jan – Mar 2026
Mentored by Shi Feng and Jacob Pfau. Empirical AI Debate. [Symposium spotlight talk](#), [LW research update](#).
- **MARS 4.0 Mentor. MARS/Geodesic Research** (Cambridge, UK) Dec 2025 – Feb 2026
Mentoring project on demonstrating [Generalisation Resistance](#) via ‘[Persona-Superposition-Collapse](#)’.
- **External Collaborator. Mary Phuong’s MATS 8.0 Stream** (Cambridge & London, UK) Jun – Aug 2025
Research on black-box detection methods for low-stakes AI control.
- **MARS 3.0 Mentor. MARS/Geodesic Research** (Cambridge, UK) Jun – Aug 2025
Mentoring project on LLM Self-Recognition as part of Geodesic Research mega-stream.
- **Co-organiser & Lecturer for AI Safety Course. Meridian/C2D3** (Cambridge, UK) Jan – Mar 2025
Co-organised and lectured for [16-lecture series](#) on ‘Language Models and Intelligent Agentic Systems’. [Recordings](#) average 400+ views per lecture.

PUBLICATIONS

- J St. Amand, C Canavan, S Imran, J Hewson, A Lutz, S Feng, P Radmard, **L Wells**. Self-Generated Text Recognition: Quality Heuristics, Cross-Task Transfer, and Downstream Bias in LLM Evaluation. In *COLM 2026*.
- L Yulong, P Bernabeu-Perez, B Arnav, **L Wells**, M Phuong. Same Question, Different Lies: Cross-Context Consistency (C³) for Black-Box Sandbagging Detection. In *ICML 2026*; [OpenReview](#).
- J Barzdukas, J Peck, J Schulz, P Rauba, **L Wells**. Model Organisms for Generalization Resistance Under Distribution Shift. In *Workshop on Principled Design for Trustworthy AI—Interpretability, Robustness, and Safety across Modalities, ICLR 2026*; [OpenReview](#); [arXiv](#).
- **L Wells**, E Young, J Brown, S Bacallado. KL-Regularised Q-Learning: A Token-Level Action-Value Perspective on Online RLHF. In *2nd Workshop on Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment, ICML 2025*; [OpenReview](#); [arXiv](#).
- G Flamich, **L Wells**. Some Notes on the Sample Complexity of Approximate Channel Simulation. Spotlighted in *Learn to Compress Workshop, ISIT 2024*; [IEEE](#); [arXiv](#).

- **L Wells**, K Thurimella, S Bacallado. Regularised Canonical Correlation Analysis: Graphical Lasso, Biplots and Beyond. [arXiv:2403.02979](#) (2024).
- J Chapman, AL Aguila, **L Wells**. Unconstrained Stochastic CCA: Unifying Multiview and Self-Supervised Learning. In *ICLR 2024*; [Proceedings](#); [arXiv](#).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Safety Research:** Strong agentic coding skills and previous experience across post-training and eval stack. Broad knowledge and deep understanding of AI safety literature.
- **Python:** numpy, matplotlib, scikit-learn, pandas, pytorch, huggingface, inspect.
- **Workflow:** VSCode/Cursor, Vim, Git, bash, GNU/Linux, L^AT_EX, Weights & Biases.
- **Languages:** English (native), French (B1/2), German (B1/2).

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Quant Research Intern.** *G-Research* (London, UK) Jun 2024 – Aug 2024
Constructed cross-sectional equities signal using various data feeds and ML techniques.
- **Quant Research Intern.** *Capula Investment Management* (London, UK) Jun 2023 – Aug 2023
Developed end-to-end futures strategy utilizing ChatGPT for sentiment analysis of central bank speeches.
- **Trading Intern.** *Susquehanna International Group* (Dublin, Ireland) Jun 2021 – Aug 2021
Completed intensive training in options theory, mock trading, and poker strategy. Conducted research project on SX5E index options.
- **Statistics Consultant.** *University of Cambridge* (Cambridge, UK) Oct 2021 – Present
Provide statistical consulting for interdisciplinary projects in neuroscience, linguistics, and engineering.
- **Teaching Assistant/Supervisor.** *University of Cambridge* (Cambridge, UK) Oct 2021 – Present
 - Analysis and Topology (2nd year)
 - Mathematics of Machine Learning (3rd year)
 - Principles of Statistics (3rd year)
 - Teaching Assistant for Bayesian Modelling and Computation

AWARDS

- **Larmor Award** Jun 2021
One of only seven undergraduates to receive prestigious college prize for “intellectual qualifications, moral conduct and practical activities”.
- **College Prize and Baylis Scholarship for Mathematics** 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021
For high first class and top mark in college in all years of undergraduate and master’s mathematics exams.

REFERENCES

Available upon request.